

Marit knew that she was changing. Suddenly, life was simple, light and airy. She smiled at everyone. And everyone smiled back. Human beings suddenly mattered. Like her driver Shajahan. Who drove her from historic Cochin to misty Munnar, from exotic Thekkady to enchanting Kumarakom, from dreamy Alleppey to sensational Kovalam. All along, he was an unobtrusive guide and a well-meaning friend. Before Marit packed her bags to leave, she decided to give Shajahan a gift - a car worth € 9500.

Today, Marit sits like a goddess on Shajahan's dashboard. And curious travellers hear the story of how his eyes filled with tears when Marit gifted him and his wife the key to a new future. As for Marit, it was just a little act of kindness inspired by *God's Own Country*.

The story of a goddess called Marit.

What's your experience? Log on to www.keralatourism.org and record your real-life Kerala experience, which could win you a free holiday. Or plan your first ever holiday in *God's Own Country*, inspired by an amazing range of true stories like that of Marit Struittburg who lives in Leiden, Netherlands.

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One of the ten paradises of the world - National Geographic Traveler